



Glossary

Here are the meanings of some words that are useful for you to know when learning about the Stone Age.

antler Special kind of bone growth on the heads of male deer that can be used to make tools such as soft hammers or needles

beliefs Set of views that people hold about the world, life, and the afterlife

blade Type of stone tool that is long and has a very sharp edge

cordage Similar to rope, and usually made from plant or animal fibers, it can be used to make containers, shelters, and clothing

digging stick Long stick used to dig up roots and vegetables that grow under the soil

drill Narrow piece of wood spun on a hearth board (see hearth) to create enough heat to make fire

evolution Gradual process by which living things change over time to adapt to their environment

foraging Gathering food that grows wild in nature

flax Plant that has natural fibers in it that can be made into cloth or cordage

flint Type of sedimentary rock that is very glassy, and produces a sharp edge when knapped

flintknapping See knapping

hammer stone Hard, rounded rock used to make stone tools such as hand axes out of glassy rocks like flint

hand ax Stone tools that could be used for cutting and chopping

harpoon Type of spear that is used when hunting from a boat on the water

hearth The place a fire burns in a shelter and the board used with a drill to make fire

horn Made out of the same stuff as your fingernails, horns grow on the head of some grass-eating animals. Also used to make containers and musical instruments

human Also called *Homo sapiens*, humans originated in Africa and have been around for at least 200,000 years

